TRI-STATE SALARY GUIDE 2027

Accounting & Finance salaries for 2027

What employers in New York, New Jersey and Connecticut are paying, so you can plan 2027 hiring with confidence.

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vacobyhighspring.github.io/solutions/salary-guide

SALARIES BY ROLE

Base salary by role

Typical 2027 base salary in New York, by experience level. Individual roles show Early career (1 to 3 years), Experienced (4 to 6 years) and Senior (7+ years). Manager, director and executive roles show the lower range, typical pay and upper range, because their pay moves with company size and scope. New Jersey and Connecticut usually pay a little less; see Pay by location.

Role	Early career / Lower range	Experienced / Typical	Senior / Upper range
CORE ACCOUNTING			
Staff Accountant	$82,000	**$82,000**	$117,000
Senior Accountant	$111,000	**$125,000**	$154,000
Accounting Manager	$138,000	**$143,000**	$186,000
Assistant Controller	$132,000	**$170,000**	$191,000
Controller	$180,000	**$234,000**	$265,000
Chief Accounting Officer	$276,000	**$300,000**	$350,000
FINANCE / FP&A			
Financial Analyst	$95,000	**$111,000**	$138,000
Senior Financial Analyst	$117,000	**$143,000**	$161,000
Finance Manager	$132,000	**$163,000**	$201,000
Director of Finance	$186,000	**$209,000**	$240,000
FP&A Analyst	$95,000	**$111,000**	$138,000
Senior FP&A Analyst	$117,000	**$148,000**	$164,000
FP&A Manager	$137,000	**$163,000**	$194,000
Senior Manager of FP&A	$149,000	**$168,000**	$183,000
Director of FP&A	$184,000	**$215,000**	$254,000
Chief Financial Officer (CFO)	$231,000	**$316,000**	$424,000
INVESTOR RELATIONS & CLIENT SERVICES			
Investor Relations Analyst	$111,000	**$123,000**	$157,000
Investor Relations Manager	$118,000	**$148,000**	$187,000
Director of Investor Relations	$150,000	**$188,000**	$236,000
Client Service Associate	$69,000	**$84,000**	$95,000
Client Service Manager	$63,000	**$106,000**	$139,000
Director of Client Services	$98,000	**$142,000**	$197,000
TECHNICAL ACCOUNTING & SEC REPORTING			
Technical Accountant	$95,000	**$117,000**	$144,000

Role	Early career / Lower range	Experienced / Typical	Senior / Upper range
Senior Technical Accountant	$115,000	**$138,000**	$166,000
Technical Accounting Manager	$136,000	**$160,000**	$184,000
AUDIT & RISK			
Internal Auditor	$78,000	**$99,000**	$134,000
Senior Internal Auditor	$109,000	**$128,000**	$150,000
Manager, Internal Audit	$127,000	**$153,000**	$183,000
Director of Internal Audit	$181,000	**$223,000**	$248,000
TAX			
Tax Accountant	$90,000	**$106,000**	$128,000
Senior Tax Accountant	$117,000	**$126,000**	$148,000
Tax Manager	$132,000	**$154,000**	$183,000
Director of Tax	$198,000	**$225,000**	$273,000
TRANSACTIONAL & OPERATIONAL ACCOUNTING			
Accounts Payable Specialist	$72,000	**$74,000**	$87,000
Senior Accounts Payable Specialist	$69,000	**$81,000**	$96,000
Accounts Payable Supervisor	$81,000	**$98,000**	$119,000
Accounts Payable Manager	$90,000	**$110,000**	$133,000
Accounts Receivable Specialist	$72,000	**$74,000**	$98,000
Accounts Receivable Supervisor	$79,000	**$95,000**	$115,000
Accounts Receivable Manager	$80,000	**$97,000**	$118,000
Payroll Specialist	$59,000	**$71,000**	$86,000
Senior Payroll Specialist	$72,000	**$89,000**	$109,000
Payroll Supervisor	$78,000	**$97,000**	$122,000
Payroll Manager	$96,000	**$120,000**	$151,000
Director of Payroll	$143,000	**$195,000**	$254,000
Bookkeeper	$64,000	**$72,000**	$82,000
TREASURY			
Treasury Analyst	$90,000	**$117,000**	$165,000
Treasury Manager	$149,000	**$175,000**	$212,000
Director of Treasury	$178,000	**$223,000**	$279,000

PAY BY INDUSTRY AND LOCATION

Where pay runs higher or lower

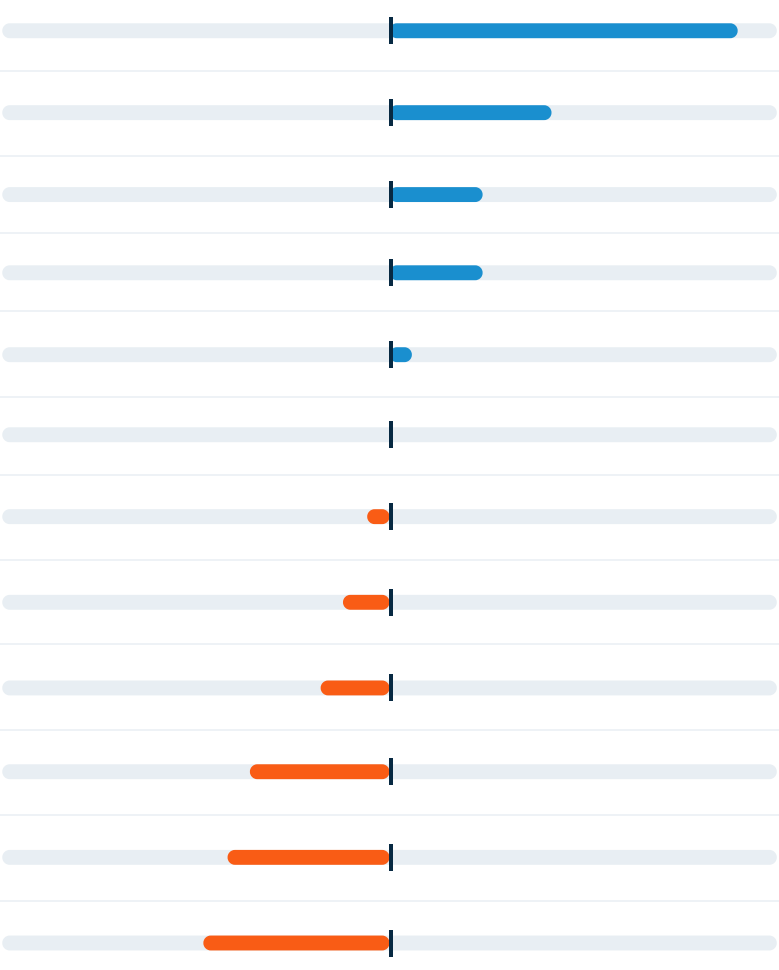
Each figure compares base salary in job postings from the last six months with the tri-state market for the same roles. The example shows what a $100,000 role would pay.

By location



New York City	**5% above market**	$100,000 role ≈ $105,000
Long Island	**In line with market**	$100,000 role ≈ $100,000
Westchester and Hudson Valley	**4% below market**	$100,000 role ≈ $96,000
New Jersey	**5% below market**	$100,000 role ≈ $95,000
Connecticut	**5% below market**	$100,000 role ≈ $95,000

By industry



Fintech	**15% above market**	$100,000 role ≈ $115,000
Hedge funds and asset management	**7% above market**	$100,000 role ≈ $107,000
Technology	**4% above market**	$100,000 role ≈ $104,000
Professional services	**4% above market**	$100,000 role ≈ $104,000
Banking and capital markets	**1% above market**	$100,000 role ≈ $101,000
Insurance	**In line with market**	$100,000 role ≈ $100,000
Manufacturing and industrial	**1% below market**	$100,000 role ≈ $100,000
Healthcare and life sciences	**2% below market**	$100,000 role ≈ $98,000
Consumer, retail and hospitality	**3% below market**	$100,000 role ≈ $97,000
Real estate and construction	**6% below market**	$100,000 role ≈ $94,000
Media, entertainment and sports	**7% below market**	$100,000 role ≈ $93,000
Nonprofit, education and government	**8% below market**	$100,000 role ≈ $92,000

BONUS AND EQUITY

What employers pay on top of salary

Almost every company has a bonus plan

Share of companies with a yearly bonus plan (short-term incentive) for at least some employees. Not every role is eligible.



Equity plans are standard at public companies

Share of companies with an equity or multi-year cash plan (long-term incentive) for at least some employees



Public companies are twice as likely to give managers equity

Share of companies that give managers a long-term incentive



How bonuses are structured

CFOS

A CFO bonus is often close to a full year's salary.

A median target bonus of 90% of salary, ranging from 50% to 175%

WALL STREET

Wall Street bonuses set the bar for finance talent.

The average New York City securities bonus was a record $246,900 for 2025, paid December to March

ACCOUNTING FIRMS

Bonuses at accounting firms are small.

Median bonuses were $750 for staff, $3,001 for seniors and about $5,500 for managers, and fell for junior staff

SIGN-ON BONUSES

Sign-on bonuses are rare in accounting, but growing.

4.2% of accounting job postings offered a signing bonus at the end of 2025, up about 2 points in a year

How equity is structured

PUBLIC COMPANIES

Expect stock units, often with performance shares.

Restricted stock units (90% of public companies) and performance shares (74%).

PRIVATE EQUITY-BACKED

A slice of a pool of about 10% of the company, paid at a sale.

Profits interests (50%), stock options (30%) or restricted shares (28%), from a pool of about 10% of the company. Payout usually depends on the multiple at sale

REFRESH GRANTS

PE-backed companies now top up executive equity more often.

At private equity-backed companies, refresh grants to executives grew from 46% to 73% of the initial grant between 2023 and 2025

PRIVATE COMPANIES

Private companies rarely give managers equity.

Only 25% of private companies give managers long-term incentives, compared with 50% of public companies

Building your offer

- Time the offer around bonus season. Finance candidates who leave before their bonus is paid expect to be made whole.
- Put the target bonus in the offer letter as a percentage of salary. Finance candidates compare targets, not promises.
- For controller and CFO hires at private equity-backed companies, explain how the equity pays out at a sale and what the hurdle is.

What leaders can expect on top of salary

Chief Financial Officer	A target bonus around the size of salary at public companies, less at private ones. Equity is standard: performance shares at public companies, a share of the company at PE-backed and venture-backed ones.
Controller / VP Finance	Expect a cash bonus first. Equity is likely at venture-backed companies, possible at public ones, and small at PE-backed ones unless the role is in the C-suite.
Assistant Controller	Mostly a cash role: plan on a bonus, and treat equity as a plus at public companies.
Finance Director / FP&A	A cash bonus in the tens of thousands, plus equity at most venture-backed and many public companies.

PERKS AND BENEFITS

Perks that win offers

How common each perk is, and which ones set you apart.

57%

FLEXIBILITY

Hybrid is getting rarer, so it stands out more

SHRM's 2026 Employee Benefits Survey found 57% of employers offer hybrid work, down from 63%. Offering it is becoming a point of difference.

27%

FLEXIBILITY

Try a work-from-anywhere window

SHRM reported 27% of employers began offering limited-time work-from-anywhere arrangements in 2026, a lower-commitment way to add flexibility.

30%

FLEXIBILITY

A four-day week is the top return-to-office incentive

In FlexJobs' survey, 30% of workers named a four-day workweek as the perk that would persuade them to return to the office full time, ahead of a raise of 15% or more (18%).

46%

FAMILY

Paid parental leave is spreading fast

SHRM's 2026 survey of 5,472 organizations found 46% now offer paid parental leave, up seven points in a year. Paid prenatal leave beyond legal requirements rose from 10% to 18%.

50%

FAMILY

Fertility and family-building coverage

Mercer found IVF coverage is now offered by 50% of large employers, and by 77% of those with 20,000 or more employees.

81%

MONEY

The 401(k) match is expected

SHRM's 2026 survey found 90% of employers offer a traditional 401(k) and 81% of them match contributions. The average maximum match is 6.11%.

10%

MONEY

Student loan help is still rare

SHRM found company-provided student loan repayment grew from 8% to 10% of employers, with the average tuition or loan repayment maximum rising to $5,546. A rare benefit is a memorable one.

33%

GROWTH

Paid AI tools are the fastest-growing perk

Employer-sponsored AI tool subscriptions jumped 17 percentage points to 33% of employers in SHRM's 2026 survey.

49%

HEALTH

Weight-loss drug coverage divides employers

Mercer found 49% of large employers covered GLP-1 drugs for weight loss, though 6% dropped coverage in 2026. Across employers of all sizes, SHRM found only 15% cover them for weight management.

2027 OUTLOOK

Accounting & Finance hiring in 2027

The numbers that matter for 2027 hiring.

In demand for 2027

No. 1

Data and AI skills now outrank FP&A

Forvis Mazars' 2026 Financial Executives Priorities Report found data, technology and AI skills have overtaken traditional FP&A as the most sought-after capabilities. 32% of organizations plan to increase headcount.

87%

Finance teams are still hiring

Consero's 2026 CFO Report found 87% of companies are increasing finance headcount, with growing demand for analytical and systems-oriented skills to support AI-enabled finance.

64%

The skills gap is the main obstacle

In Gartner's CFO community survey, 64% named lack of skills as a challenge for AI and automation in finance, ahead of legacy technology (46%) and employee adoption (44%).

47%

Analytics and business partnering are rising

The Oliver Wyman Forum and NYSE CFO survey found demand is expected to increase for enterprise steering, advanced analytics, business partnership and transformation execution, while 47% expect more centralization and shared services.

Where employers are investing

64%

AI and machine learning lead finance tech spend

Forvis Mazars found 64% of finance leaders rank AI and machine learning as their top technology investment for 2026, yet only 15% feel fully prepared to support advanced analytics and AI.

54%

AI agents are moving into finance

In Deloitte's CFO Signals survey, 54% of CFOs said integrating AI agents into finance would be one of their top transformation priorities, and 49% named automating processes as their top finance talent priority.

55%

Automation is the answer to cost pressure

Forvis Mazars reported 55% of companies are investing in operational efficiency and automation to address inflation.

44%

AI is seen as a driver of company value

FTI Consulting's 2026 Global CFO Survey found 44% of CFOs identify AI leverage as a top enterprise value driver.

What happened in 2026

+51.3%

Wall Street profits surged

The NYS Comptroller reported first-half 2026 Wall Street profits of $45.9 billion, up 51.3% from the first half of 2025.

207,400

Record securities employment in NYC

NYC securities employment hit 207,400 in 2025, the highest since tracking began in 2000. The industry is on pace to add 5,300 more city jobs in 2026.

3.4%

Finance pay outpaced the region

Private-sector wages in financial activities rose 3.4% in the year to September 2026, versus 2.6% for all Northeast private-sector wages.

60%

AI is reshaping finance roles, not erasing them

In Datarails' survey of 270 US CFOs, 60% said AI let them move staff to higher-value work. Only 3% reported actively cutting headcount where AI replaced work.

64%

Fewer junior seats, more mid-level ones

An Oliver Wyman and NYSE survey of nearly 500 CFOs found 64% expect finance teams to move away from junior roles. 41% expect more mid-level roles.

+8.9%

The CPA pipeline is starting to refill

Four-year undergraduate accounting enrollment rose 8.9% in spring 2026, to 205,180 students. First-time CPA Exam candidates in 2025 hit their highest level since 2018.

What 2027 looks like

3.7%

Financial services raises lead

Mercer projects 2027 merit budgets of 3.7% for banking and 3.6% for insurance, above its 3.2% all-industry merit figure.

3.4%

Budgets are flat to slightly lower

WTW's survey of 1,650 US organizations projects 3.4% salary increase budgets for 2027, versus 3.5% actual in 2026.

3.4% to 3.8%

Northeast forecasts vary by survey

Gallagher projects 3.8% for Northeast exempt staff in 2027, the highest region. Salary.com projects 3.4% for the Northeast, the lowest US region.

$49.2B

Bigger bonus pool expected

The NYS Comptroller expects the 2026 Wall Street bonus pool, paid in early 2027, to increase. NYC's own forecast projected a 20% decline. The 2025 pool was $49.2 billion.

36%

Small firms still can't fill jobs

In October 2026, 36% of small-business owners had openings they could not fill. A net 24% plan to raise compensation in the next three months, up 4 points.

+5%

Steady long-term demand for accountants

BLS projects accountant and auditor jobs to grow 5% from 2025 to 2035, with about 115,300 openings a year. The May 2025 national median was $83,680.

What managers need to know

Nov 21

New CPA route opens in New York

New York's alternative CPA pathway (120 credit hours plus two years of experience) takes effect November 21, 2026. The 150-hour, one-year route remains available.

2 states

New Jersey and Connecticut already changed

New Jersey's bachelor's-plus-two-years CPA pathway took effect February 11, 2026. Connecticut adopted a similar pathway effective October 1, 2025.

10+

New Jersey requires pay ranges too

Since June 1, 2025, New Jersey employers with 10 or more employees must list pay or a pay range and a benefits summary on postings. Penalties are $300 for a first violation and $600 after.

$66,300

Know the exempt salary floor

In 2026, executive and administrative employees in NYC, Long Island and Westchester must earn at least $1,275 a week ($66,300 a year) to be exempt. Elsewhere in New York, the floor is $1,199.10.

$17.00

Minimum wage pauses on January 1

The NYC, Long Island and Westchester minimum wage stays $17.00 on January 1, 2027. The Governor proposed $17.60 from March 1, 2027, if the Legislature approves.

Off limits

Don't ask about pay history

Connecticut bars employers from asking about wage history unless the applicant volunteers it. Its October 2026 law also requires pay ranges on internal postings, not just external ones.

SOURCES AND METHOD

Where the numbers come from

Sources

- Vaco by Highspring internal data.
- Current data only. Every figure was published or collected in 2026. The one exception is the U.S. Dept. of Labor wage survey, whose latest release covers May 2025.
- U.S. Dept. of Labor (BLS Occupational Employment and Wage Statistics, May 2025): New York-Newark-Jersey City metro, plus New Jersey and Connecticut statewide.
- Job postings with posted salary ranges in New York, New Jersey and Connecticut, posted in the last six months (May 10 to November 10, 2026), from Google Jobs, company career sites and job boards.
- Salary sites: Glassdoor, PayScale, Salary.com, ZipRecruiter, Built In, Comparably and Levels.fyi, New York figures, collected November 2026.
- Bonus and long-term incentives: SEC proxy filings of public companies headquartered in the New York area, and published executive pay surveys.
- Total pay with bonus: Glassdoor and PayScale New York pages that publish both base and total pay, compared page by page.
- Perks and benefits:
- Market outlook:

How the numbers are set

- Vaco by Highspring adjustment. Pay figures are adjusted using Vaco by Highspring's recruiting experience in the New York, New Jersey and Connecticut market.
- Vaco recommended offer (in each role card and the hiring advisor): a competitive offer at the typical figure and a strong offer at about the 65th percentile (the typical figure plus 60% of the way to the upper end). Offers toward the top of the range win strong candidates in a competitive search. It is Vaco's advice, not a market average.
- Vaco by Highspring internal data counts twice and is never dropped as an outlier.
- Client services roles (added November 2026). Client Service Associate, Client Service Manager and Director of Client Services use 2026 New York figures from PayScale and 2026 New York job postings in financial services.
- Yearly bonus and total pay. The bonus is how far total pay runs above base salary on Glassdoor and PayScale for the same role. Because those totals can include stock, the bonus is capped at typical 2026 bonus targets: 10% of base for early-career roles, 15% for individual and manager roles, 20% for directors and 30% for executives. The CFO is not capped, because CFO bonus targets in 2026 proxy filings run close to a full year's salary. Stock is shown separately.
- Security leadership recheck (November 2026). Director of Information Security, VP of Information Security and Chief Information Security Officer add 2026 New York figures from Salary.com, PayScale and Orbyt Salary Explorer to the job postings, Dept. of Labor and Glassdoor data. The career-ladder rule applies, so pay rises from Manager to Director to VP to CISO.
- Analytics Manager recheck (November 2026). Adds 2026 New York figures from Salary.com, ZipRecruiter, PayScale, Built In and current job postings. Typical pay moved from $126K to $138K.
- Each source counts once, except Vaco internal data. The typical salary is the middle of the sources' typical figures; the range is the middle of their low and high figures (25th and 75th percentiles where published).
- Accounting and finance titles: Early career is the staff or analyst title, Experienced is the senior title (the 4 to 6 year job), Senior is the upper end of the senior title.
- Outlier rule: any source figure more than 15% below or 35% above the middle of all sources for that role is left out, so one site that reads far off the rest cannot pull a role down or up.
- Where a senior title was combined into its base role, the Experienced figure sits between the two titles, because senior is a matter of years, not a different job.
- Job postings: the middle of posted low and high ends, and of the midpoints. Duplicates, hourly and contract roles, and postings older than six months are excluded.

- Financial Services figures use postings from banks, insurers, investment firms and private equity, plus Vaco internal data. Accounting & Finance figures exclude those employers.
- New Jersey and Connecticut are compared with New York source by source: each source's state figure is set against the same source's New York figure for that role, and the typical gap is applied to the New York pay. Where a role has fewer than two matching sources, the state's typical gap to New York is used. A state is shown above New York only when the matching sources support it.
- Industry views use real pay data. Where a role has no figure of its own for an industry (too few postings of its own), it is worked out from how that industry pays for roles in the same skill area, or else for all roles.
- Base annual salary unless stated. Bonus and equity figures are shown separately, with their sources.

TALK TO US

Want help pricing a role?

Talk to your local Vaco team for role-specific data, who is available to hire now, and help building an offer that wins.

vaco.com/contact-us

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